

STUDENT HOUSING AND ROOMMATE MATCHING

PROBLEM, SOLUTION, VALUE PROPOSITION,
AND REVENUE MODEL

PROBLEM DESCRIPTION

- Finding off-campus housing is a complex and stressful process for students, especially those moving to a new city for the first time. Students are forced to navigate an overwhelming number of housing options across fragmented platforms, often with limited or unreliable information about neighborhoods, living conditions, landlords, and potential roommates. The process is further complicated by safety concerns, including scams, deceptive listings, and the difficulty of verifying the reliability of landlords and roommates. Existing alternatives such as social media groups, leasing offices, and general rental platforms provide incomplete solutions and often create false expectations. High application fees and complex contract and payment logistics also limit students' ability to explore multiple options. As a result, students frequently make rushed decisions under pressure, increasing the risk of financial loss, unsafe living situations, and poor roommate compatibility. These challenges highlight the lack of a centralized, trustworthy, and student-oriented solution for housing and roommate discovery.

SOLUTION DESCRIPTION

- The proposed solution is a student-focused housing and roommate discovery platform that centralizes the search process and reduces uncertainty, risk, and decision fatigue. The platform is designed to support students during a short, high-intensity period, acknowledging that housing search is a temporary but critical need. Students can explore apartment listings and potential roommates through verified profiles, compatibility filters, and location-based search. A freemium model allows students to view matches freely while limiting daily interactions, encouraging thoughtful engagement without blocking access. For students who need faster coordination, a one-time 30-day access unlocks unlimited interactions during the peak search period. For landlords, the platform offers featured listings that increase visibility during periods of high demand, helping reduce vacancy time while maintaining a verified and student-only environment. By combining verification, structured information, and controlled interactions, the platform enables safer, faster, and more informed housing decisions without requiring long-term user retention. As a result, students frequently make rushed decisions under pressure, increasing the risk of financial loss, unsafe living situations, and poor roommate compatibility. These challenges highlight the lack of a centralized, trustworthy, and student-oriented solution for housing and roommate discovery.

REVENUE MODEL

Boosted Post Model (for landlords)

Landlords can pay to promote their listings

- Boosted posts will appear first in search results
- Landlord can pick the type of boost (highlight, card color, etc)

FreemiumModel (for students)

With the free tier, students can browse all apartments freely

Limitations of free tier:

- Users can only view 10 roommate cards before a 12-hour cooldown is enforced

Premium tier:

- Students can pay for a one-time access for 30 days that will unlock unlimited interactions

VALUE PROPOSITION

The app will be designed to be deleted. It solves a time-dependent problem without generating a long-term dependency. There will always be new students entering the system since the demand for the service renews naturally each semester which allows for cyclic growth and repeated monetization without artificial user retention.

FOR STUDENTS

Fast access to housing and trustworthy roommates with a flexible model that adapts in real-time during the duration of the needs

- Free to explore
- No long-term commitment or subscription

FOR LANDLORDS

Larger visibility to a student audience at the right time

- Less vacancies
- More transparency
- operating complexity removed